Chapter 28

The Governor's House Opens Up: An Irony of Fate

FROM POLICING TO RUNNING A PRISON AND FROM BOOK WRITING TO assisting the lieutenant governor of Delhi in city management was indeed a long haul. Kiran's posting as the special secretary to the lieutenant governor, Tejendra Khanna, an outstanding civil servant, happened due to an ironic quirk of destiny. Kiran had been removed from Tihar Jail by P. K. Dave, Khanna's immediate predecessor. Interestingly, she was being appointed to work in the same office in a special capacity. The waiting room in which she once spent quite a bit of time to meet the person who had removed her was converted into her office. This room was adjacent to the office of the lieutenant governor. This is what Kiran had to say on her prestigious appointment:

> After the first draft of my book (*It's Always Possible*) had been sent to the editor, I decided to report back to Delhi Police. But again I was kept waiting. Meanwhile, the Union Territory of Delhi got a new lieutenant governor, Tejendra Khanna. Mr Khanna, as I had seen and read about, was an open, honest person and a thorough professional. I sought an appointment with him to pay a courtesy call. The Delhi police commissioner reports to the lieutenant governor, Delhi. Mr Khanna discussed matters of policing in the capital with me and also my concepts of crime prevention. He listened to me with respect. Ironically again, I was before the incumbent whose predecessor had not even given me an opportunity to be heard before being removed from Tihar with the accompanying news splashed all over, despite my written requests, and here the present lieutenant governor was keen to 'hear' what I had to say. What an irony of fate!
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> I went away from the LG's office thinking I would get some place in the Delhi Police soon, whatever it might be. But instead, a few days later, I got a call from the LG's office that the LG wanted to see me. I was pleasantly surprised. I went. The LG came straight to the point and asked: 'Would you like to work with me?' I replied: 'Thank you, Sir, but what for?' He said: 'Together we work for the city and redress the people's grievances.' I said: 'Sir, it's a great opportunity, but I would prefer to return to mainstream policing at this point in my career.' He then said: 'It's fine, but do think about it and get back to me.' I went back and waited for Police Headquarters' orders on my posting. Nothing came. I got another message from the LG's office to consider the offer he had made, and to see him if the offer was acceptable. Meanwhile, information had leaked that the LG was keen to appoint me as his special secretary, as he had already appointed another recently retired senior police officer from the Central Bureau of Investigation, Shantanu Sen, as his special secretary for assisting him in law and investigation matters. Sen had had a very successful tenure with the CBI. I went to see the LG not for the posting, but to ask if I could know why I was still on hold. Mr Khanna was straightforward and